

FREE PRINTABLE

DIY Cleaning Spray Recipe Cards

Ten recipes with exact amounts, what each one is for, and the surfaces to keep it off. Cut them out or keep the sheet in the cabinet.

Every recipe fits a 16 ounce glass bottle unless it says otherwise. Mix, label with the name and the date, and remake every three to four weeks.

RECIPE 1

All purpose vinegar and lemon spray

MIX

- 1 cup distilled water
- 1 cup white vinegar
- 15 drops lemon essential oil
- 16 ounce glass bottle, shake before every use

USE IT ON

Sealed countertops, appliance fronts, the stovetop, bathroom sinks, tile backsplash. Spray, wait about 30 seconds on dried spots, wipe with a damp microfiber cloth.

KEEP IT OFF

Natural stone. Vinegar etches marble, granite, travertine and limestone for good. On stone, use 1 teaspoon of castile soap in the same water base instead.

GOOD TO KNOW

Half and half with water is the right strength. Straight vinegar cleans no better and the smell lingers.

RECIPE 2

Streak free glass and mirror spray

MIX

- 1 cup distilled water
- 1 cup white vinegar
- 1 tablespoon rubbing alcohol

USE IT ON

Mirrors, windows, glass tabletops, framed art. Mist a lint free microfiber cloth, not the glass, wipe top to bottom, then buff with the dry side of a second cloth.

KEEP IT OFF

Electronic screens, since alcohol can strip anti glare coatings. Not on a hot sunny window, where it flashes off and leaves a film.

GOOD TO KNOW

Distilled water matters most here. Tap water minerals are the spots you are trying to avoid. A bottle lasts three to four weeks.

RECIPE 3

Warm water castile soap degreaser

MIX

- 2 cups warm water
- 2 tablespoons liquid castile soap
- 10 drops orange essential oil
- Swirl, do not shake, or you get a bottle of foam

USE IT ON

Greasy stovetops, the range hood, cabinet fronts near the burners, the microwave interior. Let it sit two to three minutes, then wipe with a damp cloth. Safe on stainless steel, laminate, painted cabinets and sealed stone.

KEEP IT OFF

Never mix castile soap with vinegar. The acid turns the soap back into oils and leaves a white curd.

GOOD TO KNOW

Warm water is not optional. In cold water the soap sits in strings. For baked on splatter, spray again and lay a warm damp cloth over the spot for five minutes.

RECIPE 4

Tea tree everyday sanitizing spray

MIX

- 2 cups distilled water
- 2 tablespoons white vinegar
- 20 drops tea tree essential oil

USE IT ON

Doorknobs, light switch plates, cabinet pulls, the bathroom vanity, trash can lids. Mist and leave it visibly wet for at least ten minutes before wiping dry. Spray again if it dries early.

KEEP IT OFF

Unsealed wood, where it can pool. Keep it well away from cats: tea tree oil is toxic to them even in small amounts.

GOOD TO KNOW

A sanitizing spray for high touch spots, not an EPA registered disinfectant. Contact time is what makes it work.

RECIPE 5

Lemon and salt scrub

MIX

- Half a fresh lemon
- A small dish of coarse kosher or sea salt
- Press the cut face into the salt, then scrub with the lemon itself

USE IT ON

Sink basins, the faucet base, the drain rim. Work in tight circles, squeeze gently as you go, rinse with warm water, then dry with a towel so fresh spots do not form.

KEEP IT OFF

Natural stone and anything with a delicate finish. Acid plus grit is too much there.

GOOD TO KNOW

Does not keep. Make it per use. A slightly dried out lemon scrubs just as well as a fresh one.

RECIPE 6

Baking soda soft scrub paste

MIX

- 1/2 cup baking soda
- About 2 tablespoons liquid castile soap, added a little at a time
- 5 drops lemon or tea tree oil
- Texture like thick cake frosting

USE IT ON

Oven door glass, tub rings, tile grout, cooked on stovetop rings. Apply with a damp sponge, wait ten minutes, scrub in small circles, rinse with warm water.

KEEP IT OFF

Polished stone and brushed finishes, where any abrasive dulls the surface. Acrylic tubs over repeated use.

GOOD TO KNOW

Does not store. It dries into a brick within days, so mix only what the job needs.

RECIPE 7

Lavender linen and room spray

MIX

- 1 cup distilled water
- 2 tablespoons rubbing alcohol
- 20 drops lavender essential oil
- Glass bottle, shake right before misting

USE IT ON

Curtains, throw pillows, made beds, inside closets. Hold the bottle an arm's length away so you get a fine cloud rather than wet dots.

KEEP IT OFF

Spot test any fabric first. Alcohol can affect some dyes and delicate weaves.

GOOD TO KNOW

The scent lasts about twenty minutes. Good for a quick refresh before guests, not an all day fragrance.

RECIPE 8

Olive oil and lemon wood conditioner

MIX

- 3/4 cup olive oil
- 1/4 cup fresh lemon juice
- Small glass bottle, shake hard before use

USE IT ON

Sealed and oiled hardwoods, wooden shelving, trim. Spray onto a soft cotton cloth, never onto the wood, and wipe along the grain in a thin even film.

KEEP IT OFF

High gloss lacquered or painted surfaces, where it looks smeary.

GOOD TO KNOW

A little goes a long way. Lay oily cloths flat to dry or rinse them, since a crumpled oily rag can combust. Keep the bottle in the fridge and mix small amounts.

RECIPE 9

Baking soda carpet and upholstery deodorizer

MIX

- 1 cup baking soda
- 15 drops essential oil (lavender, eucalyptus or peppermint)
- A jar with holes in the lid, or an old spice shaker

USE IT ON

Carpets, area rugs, upholstered cushions. Sprinkle generously. Fifteen minutes freshens a mild smell; set in pet or cooking odors need hours, overnight is best. Vacuum in slow overlapping passes and empty the canister.

KEEP IT OFF

Skip it if a robot vacuum runs unattended. A heavy layer gums up the brush.

GOOD TO KNOW

Baking soda neutralizes the acidic molecules behind the smell instead of covering them, which is why the result outlasts a spray.

RECIPE 10

Baking soda and vinegar drain refresh

MIX

- 1/2 cup baking soda, straight down the drain
- 1/2 cup white vinegar, then cover the opening with a plate or wet cloth
- A full kettle of freshly boiled water to flush
- Optional: 3 to 5 drops peppermint oil after

USE IT ON

Kitchen and bathroom sinks, once a month. Let the covered reaction work for about fifteen minutes, then flush.

KEEP IT OFF

A fully blocked drain. This is a freshener and a preventive rinse, not a clog buster.

GOOD TO KNOW

Safe for septic systems and every common pipe material, unlike caustic drain openers.

EVERY BOTTLE

Rules that make these work

- Distilled water in every water based recipe. The mineral spots and short shelf life people blame on homemade sprays come from tap water.
- Label each bottle with the recipe and the date. Three weeks later you will not remember which one is safe on stone.
- Mist the cloth, not the surface, for glass, wood and delicate finishes. Spraying the surface is what causes runs and streaks.
- Small batches every three to four weeks. No preservative means a fresh half bottle beats a full stale one.
- Stick to the drop counts. More essential oil does not clean better, it only irritates skin and lungs.

NEVER MIX

Keep these apart

Vinegar + bleach, ammonia or peroxide	The combinations release toxic gases. Keep vinegar sprays separate from any store product with those in it.
Castile soap + vinegar	The acid breaks the soap back into oils and leaves a white curd.
Vinegar or the lemon scrub + natural stone	Marble, granite, travertine and limestone etch permanently. Use the castile soap and water spray on stone.
Tea tree, peppermint, eucalyptus, citrus oils + cats	Toxic to cats even in small amounts, and worth checking for dogs.
Oily wood polish cloths + a warm pile	Lay them flat to dry or rinse them before laundering.

Start with recipes 1, 2 and 3. They replace the three bottles most people buy.